

Classic Tales

Akbar and Birbal: Counting the Crows



KIDS BOOK VIDEOS



Long, long ago, a great king named Akbar ruled over the land. In his grand court sat a minister named Birbal — the cleverest man anyone knew.

One fine morning, King Akbar stroked his beard and asked a tricky question. "Birbal, tell me — how many crows are there in my kingdom?"



All the courtiers looked at each other. Who could ever count the crows?



Birbal smiled and bowed. "Your Majesty," he said, "there are exactly four thousand, three hundred and fifty-six crows in your kingdom."



The king's eyes went wide. "You answer so quickly, Birbal. Are you sure?"



"Quite sure, Your Majesty," said Birbal.



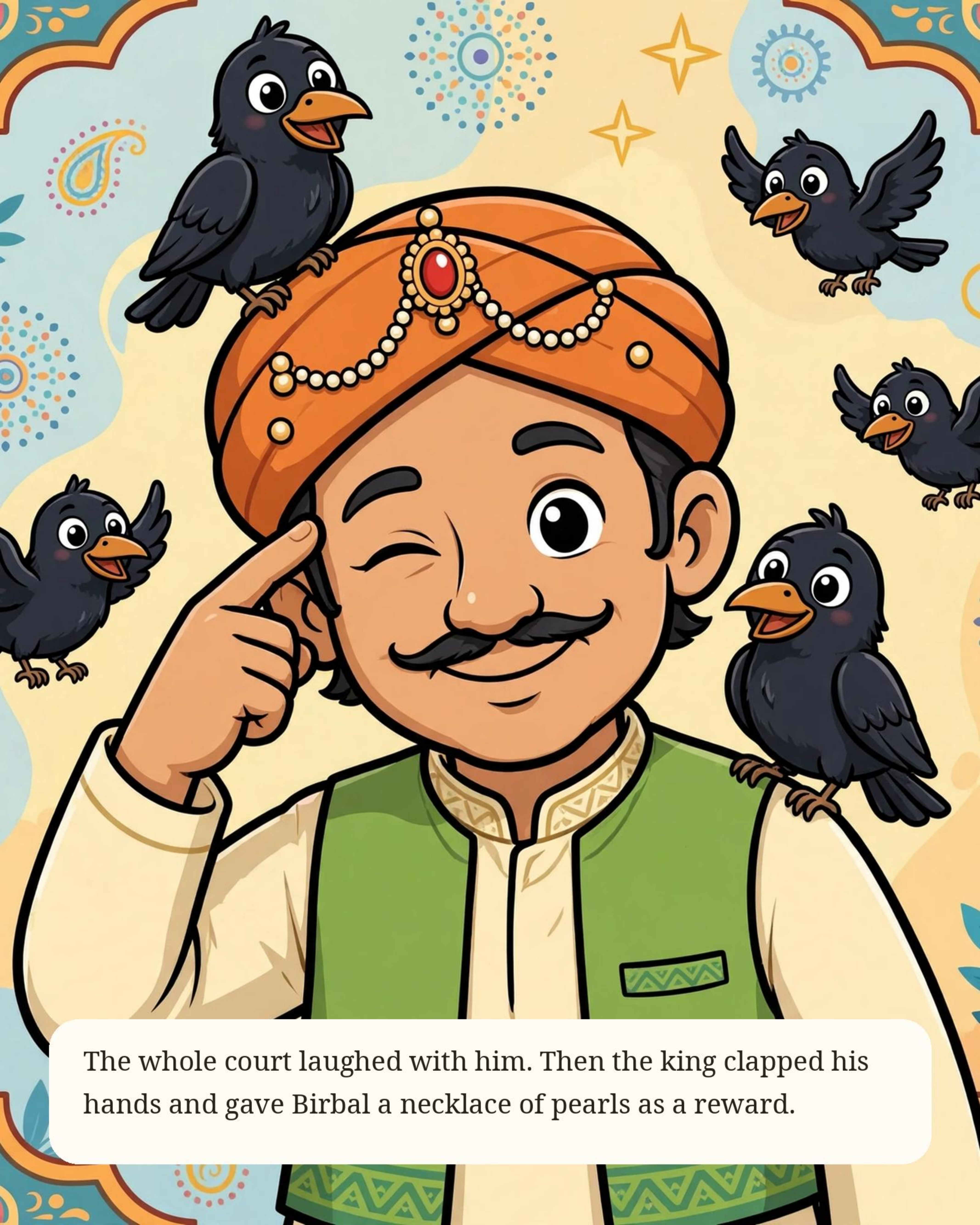
"And if anyone counts more, it means crows from other kingdoms have come to visit their relatives."



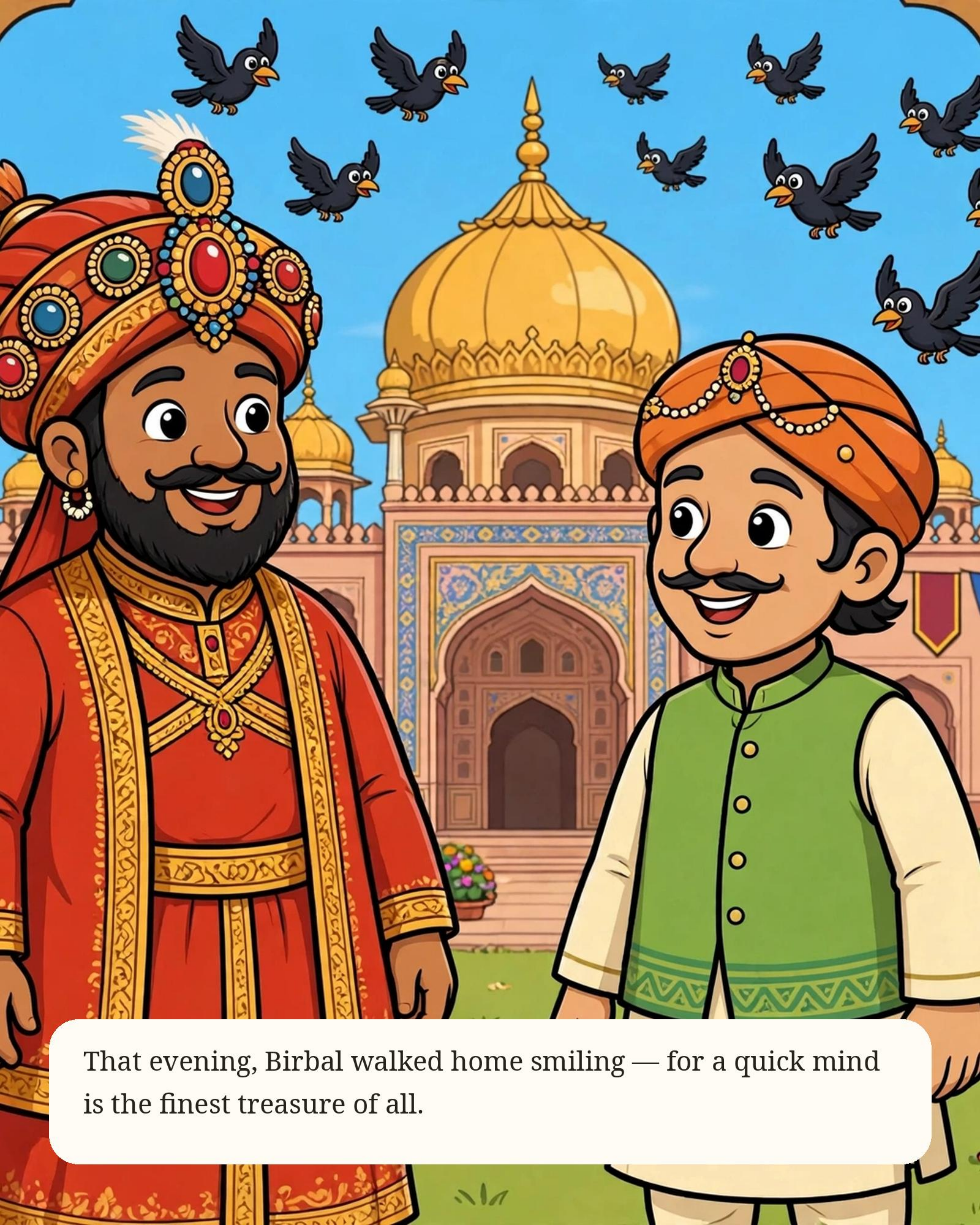
And if anyone counts fewer, it means our crows have gone on a little holiday!"



King Akbar threw back his head and laughed. "Ha-ha-ha!"



The whole court laughed with him. Then the king clapped his hands and gave Birbal a necklace of pearls as a reward.



That evening, Birbal walked home smiling — for a quick mind is the finest treasure of all.

A clever, quick answer can solve
even the trickiest question.

The End

